



HOW MUCH TECHNOLOGY CAN ONE 'PLAY' WITH?

There is a lot of electronics embedded in the stadia, media pits, players' clothes, and even in bats and balls. These help in fitness and performance analysis, training, fair play, and spectator comfort and security. Yet, there is a need to decide how much of technology to deploy in a game

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Babak Rafati became a FIFA referee in 2008 after only two-and-a-half years and 34 matches in the Bundesliga. Rafati always preferred watching the referee to the team in a football match and decided to become a referee at 16. Today, he is a Union of European Football Associations (UEFA) Category 3 referee. A passion-driven referee and a perfectionist, he felt very humiliated when he allowed a controversial goal to stand in a Bundesliga match this

March. You might think it's a small error but one goal can cost a match. There are countries where sport is a religion, while in some it's a business. Whatever the case, sport is one arena where egos are the biggest, and nobody likes mistakes—especially when it involves scores.

A referee cannot have camera vision. He is after all a human. That is the reason why the team managers and referees approached FIFA after the match, to once again appeal for technology aids on the field, especially along the goal-line. This

is something that stakeholders have been requesting FIFA for long. Excellent technologies like Hawk-Eye are commercially available for tracking a ball's movement, but FIFA seems to be moving cautiously, because they feel technology once deployed cannot be 'un-invented' once everybody starts relying on it. A proper dose of tech can aid a game; an overdose can kill sportsmanship.

However, from the speed at which technology is being adopted worldwide to assist in various aspects of almost all games, it is evident that FIFA